

Spark + Ember | Teacher Guide

October 5-8, 2026 | Grades K-8

Run the matched week

Theme: Small Moves, Strong Finish. Morning Spark gives students a low-demand entry task and a reason to notice, infer, and choose. Ember asks students to name what they actually did and its effect.

7:15: greet by name at the door; point to the Do Now. Students answer independently in 3-5 minutes. K-2 read a book afterward; grades 3-8 move to the displayed IXL Math/Reading codes. In the 2-3 deck, grade 2 reads and grade 3 uses IXL.

Announcements are the hard stop, about 7:37. After announcements, run a reveal for no more than two minutes. Give 10 seconds to think; invite one or two responses. On Monday, keep feelings private and invite volunteers only. At 7:45, hand off to Morning Meeting.

Ember: open the board and place a reflection slip before 2:05. Keep the original flow: 2:05 seated pack-up, 2:08 calm-down video or breathing fallback, 2:13 written/drawn reflection, then seated waiting. Release only on the adult announcement. Retain the existing route order and numbered Chromebook cart return.

The existing Ember board shows walkers at 2:10, car riders/aftercare and activities at 2:15, then buses K-2 at 2:17, 3-5 at 2:20, and 6-8 at 2:23. These inherited times remain subject to the campus dismissal plan; the clock display never authorizes students to leave.

Use the classroom decks Monday through Thursday, October 5-8. Thursday's reflection gives students a chance to name a finish and a habit they will carry forward.

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Daily delivery and reveal

Monday - Check-In: distribute a folded private slip. K-1 draw/point; 2-3 name a feeling and first move; 4-5 rate energy and choose a helpful action; 6-8 name an action within their control. Reveal: feelings belong, and a concrete next move can help. Never display or cold call an individual check-in. Review support requests promptly and follow established support procedures.

Tuesday - Picture of the Day: the illustrated workspace shows loose paper, an open backpack, a closed folder, a pencil, and a chair in the walkway. K-1 notice one thing; 2-3 connect a change to a reason; 4-5 use two visible details; 6-8 separate observation from inference. Reveal accepts more than one defensible answer. Do not infer who created the mess.

Wednesday - Zoom In: the close-up shows zipper teeth. Reveal the full zipper. K-1 identify it; 2-3 name a clue; 4-5 identify two clues and a function; 6-8 revise an inference and explain how the parts work together. Treat a changed guess as use of evidence.

Thursday - Would You Rather: K-1 choose paper or chair; 2-3 choose papers or walkway; 4-5 and 6-8 choose finishing a task or improving a shared space/system. The voting controls are optional. Invite a reason and a fair retelling of another choice. There is no single correct vote.

Daily Ember: Monday names a small action; Tuesday its effect on a shared space or person; Wednesday a retry, help, or revision; Thursday a completed loose end or practice to carry forward. Accept a drawing, dictated response, or accommodated response. No public disclosures are required.

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Prepare, coach, and verify

Prepare: open the grade-band Spark deck in Chrome; test English/Spanish read aloud and full screen. Keys 1-4 select a day; arrows move Do Now -> Reveal -> Handoff. Repeat aloud runs the entry prompt for staggered arrivals. Whole-week view lets teachers preview every slide.

Print: Spark pages include three Monday check-in slips per sheet and one response page for each Tuesday-Thursday prompt. Ember sheets include two matching slips per day. Set a fixed paper/pencil location and a private check-in collection spot. Review slips before students leave whenever follow-up is needed.

Clarity: give the same short entry cue: "Do Now first, then read/IXL." **Access:** let students draw, point, dictate, use the sentence frame, or use an appropriate lower-demand band. **Regulation:** offer a brief settling option and return to the task. Honor existing IEP/504 supports.

Expectation practice uses See-It / Name-It / Do-It: show the entry or seated dismissal move; name the observable action; rehearse it with a brief reset. **Recognition** names sustained evidence of Safe, Respectful, or Responsible using the established LiveSchool categories.

IXL: the dated package uses Week 6 from the existing August 31 start-date rule. Codes are embedded from the current source snapshot and refreshed from the existing IXL data URL. Source-missing codes display a dash; use the grade-specific IXL link to resolve them, never invent a replacement.

Weekly Videos and Do Now - First 5 Relax/Excite links remain visible on the package hub alongside the band decks and printables. Ember retains the current age-band regulation clips and offline breathing fallback.

Sources: live Morning Meeting Playbook, existing Morning Spark guide/decks, existing Ember boards, and Matchbook Learning IXL data. This package supplies fresh weekly prompts; it preserves the established arrival and dismissal system.